Rachel Y. L. Fung 馮睿凌

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Placement Director	Gianluca Violante	violante@princeton.edu	609-258-4003
Graduate Administrator	Laura Hedden	lhedden@princeton.edu	609-258-4006

Office Contact Information

Locust Street Building, W004
615 Locust Street
Columbia, MO 65211

Employment

University of Missouri 2024–Present

Postdoctoral Fellow in Health Economics and Policy

Graduate Studies

Princeton University 2018–2024

PhD in Economics

Dissertation: *"Essays on Gender and Policy"*

References

Professor Leah Platt Boustan	Professor Ilyana Kuziemko	Professor Michael F. Pesko
Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
Yale University	Princeton University	University of Missouri
leah.boustan@yale.edu	kuziemko@princeton.edu	peskom@missouri.edu

Prior Education

The London School of Economics and Political Science 2017–2018

MSc in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics, *Distinction*

The London School of Economics and Political Science 2014–2017

BSc in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics, *First Class Honours*

Fields

Primary	Labor, Health
Secondary	Public

Job Market Paper

"Housing Market Shocks and the Persistent Decline in U.S. Fertility".

Fertility in the United States declined sharply following the Great Recession and has remained persistently low despite the subsequent economic recovery. This paper examines whether the housing bust contributed to this sustained decline. Using variation across metropolitan areas in the severity of the housing bust, I show that more exposed MSAs experienced substantially larger declines in fertility after the recession. These effects persist through 2022, are similar across several measures of housing-market exposure, and are not explained by differential deterioration in local labor markets. The fertility response also persists even as mortgage lending and residential construction recover from their recession lows. To investigate potential channels, I examine housing and household outcomes among young adults. Young adults in more exposed MSAs became more likely to live with their parents and less likely to form partnered households, own homes, and move. The persistence of the fertility effects across successive cohorts of young women suggests that the response was not confined to those directly exposed to the housing bust during young adulthood. These findings suggest that persistent disruptions to housing and household transitions following the housing bust contributed to the long-run decline in U.S. fertility.

Publications

1. "E-Cigarettes in Historical Context—Innovation, Risk and Regulation," with Michael F. Pesko, Jamie Hartmann-Boyce, and Neal L. Benowitz.
   JAMA Health Forum, 2025.
2. "Standardising the Measurement of Cigar Tax Rates in the United States, 2010–2024," with Guthrie Scoblic, Abigail Friedman, and Michael F. Pesko.
   Tobacco Control, 2026.
3. "GLP-1s and Medicaid: Insights From Policy and Prescription Data," with Lauren Tonti and Michael F. Pesko.
   Medical Care Research and Review, 2026.
4. "E-cigarettes and Planned Smoking Cessation," with Michael F. Pesko.
   Forthcoming, *American Journal of Health Economics*.

Working Papers

1. "The Power of Tubal Sterilization: Permanent Contraception, Fertility, and Female Labor Supply."
   Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of Labor Economics*.
2. "Early Cigarette Prohibition During War and Peace," with Lauren Hoehn-Velasco and Michael F. Pesko.
3. "Medicaid Coverage of GLP-1 Medications for Obesity: Effects on Behavioral Health Treatments," with Michael F. Pesko.
4. "Does Curriculum Matter? The Effects of HIV/AIDS Education Mandates on Teen Fertility," with Jessica Min.

5. "Welfare Reform and Fertility."

Work in Progress

1. "The Impact Of Hearing Aid Insurance Coverage On Health And Social Outcomes," with Michael F. Pesko, Brandy Lipton, Benjamin Ukert, and Michelle Arnold.
2. "Effects Of State Hearing Aid Mandates On Employment, Wellbeing, And Public Benefit Receipt," with Christopher Lowenstein, Brandy Lipton, Michelle Arnold, Benjamin Ukert, and Michael F. Pesko.
3. "The Effects of Cigar Taxes on Cigar Prices and Tobacco Product Sales: Evidence from Retail Panel Data," with Guthrie Scoblic, Abigail Friedman, and Michael F. Pesko.

Professional Activities

Presentations

2027 ASSA Annual Meeting, Tobacco Online Policy Seminar

2026 University of Kansas, Missouri FSRDC, Kansas Health Economics Conference, ASHEcon Conference

2025 Kansas Health Economics Conference, ASHEcon Conference, SOLE World Labor Conference, Tobacco Online Policy Seminar

2024 CES North America Conference, PAA Annual Meeting, Family Policy and Population Research Forum (UN Commission on Population and Development), APPAM Fall Research Conference

Referee Service

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Journal of Health Economics, Tobacco Control, Addiction

Fellowships and Awards

Clarence J. Hicks Memorial Fellowship, Princeton University	2023–2024
NBER Gender in the Economy Fellowship Runner-up	2023–2024
Graduate Student Fellow, Griswold Center for Economic Policy Studies	2022–2023
Graduate Student Teaching Prize, Department of Economics, Princeton University	2022
Princeton Graduate Economics Fellowship	2019–2022
J. Edward Lundy *40 Fellowship for Economics, Princeton University	2018–2019
Centaline Charity Fund Scholarship	2015–2018

Teaching

Princeton	ECO 981 Junior Independent Work (TA, 2023–2024)
	ECO 313 Econometric Applications (TA, Spring 2023)
	ECO 312 Econometrics: A Mathematical Approach (TA, Fall 2020, Spring 2022)
	ECO 302 Econometrics (TA, Spring 2021, Fall 2021)
LSE	EC210 Macroeconomic Principles (TA, 2017–2018)

Additional Information

Citizenship Hong Kong

Languages Cantonese (Native), English (Native), Mandarin (Native), French (Intermediate)

Last updated: November 2026